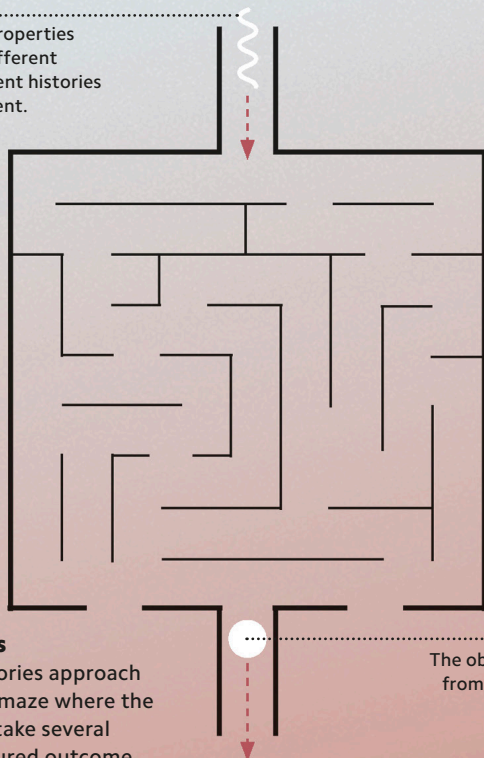


WAVE FUNCTION

The wave function's properties may evolve in many different ways, following different histories prior to its measurement.



Sifting outcomes

The consistent histories approach can be likened to a maze where the wave function can take several routes to the measured outcome.

PARTICLE

The observed properties arise from the unseen histories of a quantum object.

THROUGH THE MAZE

Sometimes referred to as “Copenhagen done right,” the consistent histories approach attempts to marry quantum mechanics with the “classical” rules of mathematical probability. In this approach, the wave function never collapses, but instead decoheres (see p.75) to reveal the properties of the quantum system at that moment in time. A set of potential “histories” describing the possible evolution of the system can be mapped out, with a certain probability assigned to each.